

SACHIN KUMAR SHUKLA

AI Product Manager | Founding Engineer | LLMs • Civic Tech • FinTech

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Founding engineer turned AI Product Manager with 5+ years building AI-first products across FinTech, EdTech, and E-commerce. I own the problem from market sizing to technical feasibility — translating ambiguous user needs into shipped AI products, defining latency and trust requirements engineering teams can build against, and connecting product strategy to measurable outcomes. Co-founded an EdTech platform scaled to 7,000+ daily active learners and currently building Rajniti, an open-source AI civic-research tool for Indian voters.

EXPERIENCE

FinSoftAI — Founding Product Manager (AI) • Remote

Jan 2023 – Present

AI-powered equity-research and sentiment-trading platform for US retail traders. Owned the research-to-signal product and its real-time trust layer.

- ▶ Defined and shipped an AI equity-research product that turns raw social-sentiment data into actionable market intelligence for **1,000+ active traders** — owning the roadmap from problem definition through launch with a 3-engineer platform team.
- ▶ Set the product requirements for an agentic AI pipeline, establishing a **<1.5s TTFT latency SLA** as a hard product constraint — because real-time trading decisions are unusable above that threshold. Translated this into testable acceptance criteria for engineering.
- ▶ Drove the build-vs-architecture trade-off to adopt Elasticsearch over a relational store for sentiment indexing, unlocking **sub-second query performance** that was the gating dependency for the core product value proposition.
- ▶ Designed the fallback UX for LLM timeout and failure scenarios — enforcing graceful degradation so traders always receive usable data, reducing AI-failure-driven session drop-off and protecting trust in a high-stakes financial context.
- ▶ Partnered with the ML/data team to define data contracts and integration specs, **cutting inter-team blocking cycles** by standardizing schema agreements upfront before build.

Saara — Founding Product Manager • Remote

Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

B2B SaaS that helps e-commerce merchants reduce and manage returns. Owned the merchant-facing returns workflow and the integrations roadmap.

- ▶ Owned the merchant returns-reduction workflow end-to-end — translating merchant feedback into a notification microservice (logistics + Twilio telephony integrations) that automated the return-resolution journey and removed a major source of manual merchant effort.
- ▶ Diagnosed a **40% frontend performance gap** via Lighthouse audits and prioritized the fix (code-splitting, lazy-loading) as a retention lever — slow dashboards were a leading driver of merchant churn risk.
- ▶ Identified a delivery bottleneck in the monolithic frontend and drove adoption of a micro-frontend architecture that **unblocked 2 parallel feature teams** from deployment conflicts — a velocity decision framed around shipping faster, not just cleaner code.
- ▶ Set a **30% backend sync-time improvement target** against merchant SLA commitments and led execution (async queuing) to meet it.

VENTURES

The Boring Education — Co-Founder & Product Lead

Jun 2022 – Present

Open-source tech-education platform for India. Owned product, growth, and the learning experience for college students and early-career professionals.

- ▶ Scaled the platform from **0 to 7,000+ daily active learners** by defining and launching autonomous full-stack programs, tech challenges, and interview-prep tools — owning the roadmap, retention loops, and community-led GTM with zero paid acquisition.

- ▶ Built a community of **100,000+** and personally mentored **900+ learners** — using direct user contact as a continuous-discovery channel that shaped the product roadmap.
- ▶ Defined the product's north-star around learner activation and built habit loops (challenges, streaks, structured tracks) that drove repeat engagement.

Gangs of Hackspur — Co-Founder

May 2018 – Aug 2020

First startup — an exam-prep platform for university students. Owned product, curriculum, and growth.

- ▶ Built and grew an exam-prep platform to **2,000+ paying users** across 10+ university courses — self-taught the full web stack to ship the product, and ran the acquisition (Facebook Ads, analytics) and curriculum strategy.

OPEN-SOURCE & PRODUCT PROJECTS

- ▶ **Rajniiti** — Open-source AI civic-research tool for Indian voters. Acting as PM and builder: authored the market-sizing model (970M TAM), competitive positioning, RICE-prioritized roadmap, OKRs, and a Trust & Safety framework for responsible AI in a civic context.
- ▶ **Chitthi** — Open-source BYOK email-sending microservice in Golang, **used by 100+ developers**. Owned the developer-experience decisions: API simplicity, self-host setup, and onboarding.
- ▶ **Trilingo** — Founding engineer on a tribal-language learning platform; achieved **60% user retention** by cutting initial load time from 4s to 0.7s (Jul 2020 – Jul 2021).

SKILLS

Product: Market Sizing (TAM/SAM/SOM), RICE & Kano Prioritization, OKRs, Roadmapping, PRDs, A/B Testing & Experimentation, AARRR Analytics, Competitive Teardowns, GTM Strategy, Unit Economics, OST (Continuous Discovery), Stakeholder Management, Responsible AI / Trust & Safety

AI / ML: LLMs, RAG, AI Agents, LangChain, LangGraph, Vector DBs (ChromaDB), MCP, Token Economics & Inference-Cost Modeling, Prompt Engineering

Engineering: JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, Golang · React, Next.js, React Native · Node, Express, FastAPI, Django · PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, ElasticSearch · AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes

Design & Data: Figma, Framer · SQL · Mixpanel/GA-style funnel & cohort analysis

EDUCATION

Vellore Institute of Technology, Vellore

Jul 2016 – Jun 2020